



Retention money nobody can **sit on**

A Solana program keeps a subcontractor's 5% in a vault owned by nobody, and releases it automatically when the warranty ends.

Stablecoin rails

Anchor · Token-2022 · Solana Actions

First test market: Kazakhstan

THE PROBLEM

£8 bn

of subcontractors' own money went unpaid in England over 3 years

44%

of contractors lost retention because an upstream company went insolvent

£27,300 lost per contract on average

43%

of US subcontractors wait over 90 days for final payment and retainage

nearly one in five waits 6 months or more

92%

of US subcontractors floated payroll from their own pocket while waiting to be paid

survey of 492 firms, May 2026

HOW IT WORKS TODAY

The client keeps 5% of every payment "as a warranty" for 1–2 years

\$190,000 paid to the subcontractor

\$10,000 held back

A \$200,000 contract. The held-back \$10,000 sits in the client's own account, mixed with their other money.

Delayed

The warranty ends and the answer is "next month". The subcontractor chases the money.

Spent

For the client it is free working capital for the next project.

Lost

If the client goes bankrupt, the retention goes to their creditors. As happened with Carillion in 2018.

WHY NOW

Governments admit the problem, but their fixes are blunt

New Zealand • 2023

Law: retention must be held in trust in a separate bank account, with a ledger per contract.

Costly, and still controlled by the party that owes the money.

United Kingdom • 2025

After a consultation, cash retentions are to be banned, not before 2027.

The client loses the quality guarantee.

Kazakhstan • 2025-26

KZTE tenge stablecoin pilot and a KASE × Solana Foundation MoU on tokenization.

Money is arriving on-chain in the local currency.

Holdback is the third way: the retention stays, but it cannot be abused.

THE SOLUTION

Four rules enforced by a program, not by people

01 · SPLIT

Each invoice is split in one transaction: **95%** to the subcontractor, **5%** into the vault.



02 · VAULT

The vault is a program address with no key. The client cannot take it back.



03 · DEFECT

Only the cost of a defect is frozen. An arbiter settles disputes.



04 · RELEASE

After the date, **anyone** clicks a Blink and the money goes to its owner.

No calls, no begging, no lawsuits. The subcontractor sees the money in real time.

WHAT A BANK CANNOT DO

Retention becomes an asset you can sell today

The subcontractor needs cash now, not in 2 years. They list their claim on the vault at 90%.

A funder pays, and the claim moves to them **in the same transaction**. Nobody can take the money without handing over the claim.

When the warranty ends, the vault pays the funder.

Subcontractor gets now	\$4,050
Funder receives at the end	\$4,500
Funder's return	+11%
Funder's risk	the money is already in the vault, not a promise to pay

HOW WE USE SOLANA

A real program, not a wallet button

Anchor program

7 instructions: create contract, pay with split, raise defect, resolve, list claim, buy claim, release.

PDA vault

The vault has no private key. Only the program can sign a transfer, and only by the rules.

Atomicity

Splitting a payment and selling a claim are single transactions: all or nothing.

Token-2022

Works with both token standards: USDC, KZTE or any stablecoin.

Solana Actions

The release button is a Blink: a link anyone can click.

Cost

0.000005 SOL per action. The whole 8-transaction scenario costs a fraction of a cent.

CONTRACT

Turan Residences, electrical, block B

Vault: AaRCko...q5SF · retention 5%

🔒 Program vault (owned by nobody)

\$5,000

Paid by invoices: \$100,000

* Frozen for a defect: \$500

Will receive the funds: Subcontractor: Volt Electric



Warranty ends in

49 s

seconds in the demo, 1-2 years in real life

Last invoice → subcontractor
(95%)**\$47,500**

Last invoice → vault (5%)

\$2,500

PARTICIPANT WALLETS (TEST USDC)

Developer: Turan Build

FHDfoz...DzY9

\$99,900,000**Subcontractor: Volt Electric**

3jy8LX...huiV

\$95,000**Arbiter: site inspector**

7jqA1D...UiPR

\$0**Funder / lender**

3G3zNQ...9pUM

\$200,000**Anyone (a stranger)**

4NGadk...yij6

\$0

WHY SOLANA

Transactions on-chain

4

All fees together

0.000020 SOL

Every action confirms in seconds and costs a fraction of a cent, with no bank in between.

ACTIONS

1. Create contract

Developer · 5% retention

2. Pay invoice \$50,000

Developer · the program splits the payment

3. Report a \$500 defect

Developer · only the repair cost is frozen

4. Settle the dispute

Arbiter · \$500 goes to repair

5. Sell the retention now at 90%

Subcontractor · cash today, not in 2 years

6. Buy the claim

Funder · payment and ownership change atomically

HOLDBACK · SOLANA ACTION

localhost/release · Blink

Holdback: release retentionTuran Residences, electrical, block B. \$5,000 in the vault.
Warranty still running.**Release funds**

RECORDED ON-CHAIN

6:51:02 AM	Developer: Turan Build	Reported defect "sparking socket", froze \$500 (photo hash on-chain)	3H37PiZv...s3mnAo	0.000005 SOL
6:51:01 AM	Developer: Turan Build	Paid invoice \$50,000 → \$47,500 to subcontractor + \$2,500 into the vault (one transaction)	5Edw8i4r...WPFSME	0.000005 SOL

MARKET

Retention is standard on construction sites almost everywhere

COUNTRY	CALLED	TYPICAL SIZE	WHAT WE KNOW
England	retention	3–5%	£3.2–5.9 bn is held at any time during a year
United States	retainage	5–10%	43% of subcontractors wait over 90 days
New Zealand	retention money	5–10%	law requires a separate trust account
Canada	holdback	10%	statutory holdback in provincial law
Russia, Kazakhstan	warranty retention	5%	a common clause in contractor agreements (Kazakhstan to be verified by interviews)

Model (hypothesis): 0.5% of held amount from the client plus a fee on claim sales.

Sources: Fenwick Elliott; Sitaline 2026; NZ Act 2023. Typical sizes in the US, Canada and NZ are indicative and need verification

ALTERNATIVES

Why this beats what exists

	CLIENT'S OWN ACCOUNT	BANK TRUST ACCOUNT	BAN ON RETENTION	HOLDBACK
Protected from bankruptcy	no	yes	n/a	yes*
Paid out without asking	no	no	n/a	yes
Subcontractor sees the money	no	on request	n/a	in real time
Client keeps the quality guarantee	yes	yes	no	yes
Cash before the warranty ends	no	no	n/a	sell the claim

Among 5,428 projects in the Colosseum database, none is about construction retention.

* the money is outside the client's account; how a court treats it in a bankruptcy has not been tested

PLAN

From Shymkent to countries where the law demands it

Now

10 interviews: 7 subcontractors and 3 developers in Shymkent. Goal: 2–3 letters of intent.

5 weeks

Devnet pilot on one real contract with test money, plus an auditor dashboard.

Next

New Zealand and Australia: a cheaper way to comply with trust-account laws. Then the US.

Biggest risk

Clients benefit from holding the money. Our answer: the law (NZ), better subcontractors, and an alternative to the UK ban.

Not yet verified

How often retention is delayed in Kazakhstan, and what a developer would pay. This is what we learn first.



A subcontractor's money sits with **rules**, not with the debtor

We are looking for 3 developers and 10 subcontractors for a pilot in Kazakhstan.

Demo works

7 tests pass

Open source